

Standard Cleaning Checklists

STR / Airbnb Turnover · Office · Commercial

Task-level checklists for every visit, built on current industry standards and Novara's own scope levels — distinct from the walkthrough/assessment checklists used for pricing.

This is a living baseline. Real job outcomes — QC cases, re-cleans, reviews, and duration variance — feed back into these checklists through the checklist feedback loop. Every change is a human decision and is versioned, so a job always reflects the checklist that was current when it was performed.

The small grey code under each task is its stable item ID — what a QC case or re-clean references, so signal survives a rewording.

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Part A — STR / Airbnb Turnover

Cleanliness is the #1 driver of negative reviews on STR platforms. A missed detail here is discovered by the next guest, not a supervisor.

BEFORE STARTING

- ☐ Confirm checkout time and next check-in time — know the hard deadline
str.before.deadline
- ☐ Quick walkthrough for damage or missing items — report immediately, don't wait
str.before.damage_walk
- ☐ Collect all trash from every room, bathroom, and outdoor area; replace all liners
str.before.trash_collect
- ☐ Strip all beds and collect used towels/linens — start laundry immediately if on-site, or bag for pickup
str.before.strip_linens
- ☐ Open windows briefly to air out the space while cleaning, weather permitting
str.before.air_out

KITCHEN

- ☐ Clear all leftover food and guest items
str.kitchen.clear_food
- ☐ Wipe stovetop, burner grates, behind/under knobs
str.kitchen.stovetop
- ☐ Clean inside microwave (turntable, walls, seal)
str.kitchen.microwave_interior
- ☐ Wipe exterior of all appliances
str.kitchen.appliance_exteriors
- ☐ Clean inside fridge — remove guest food, wipe shelves
str.kitchen.fridge_interior
- ☐ Run dishwasher or hand-wash all dishes
str.kitchen.dishes
- ☐ Check utensils, glasses, mugs for cleanliness
str.kitchen.dishware_check
- ☐ Wipe counters, backsplash, cabinet fronts
str.kitchen.counters
- ☐ Clean sink and faucet
str.kitchen.sink
- ☐ Restock coffee/tea/paper goods to host spec
str.kitchen.restock
- ☐ Take out trash and recycling
str.kitchen.trash_out

BATHROOM(S)

- ☐ Clean toilet completely — bowl, seat both sides, base, behind
str.bath.toilet
- ☐ Clean shower/tub, fixtures, drain
str.bath.shower
- ☐ Clean sink, faucet, counter, mirror
str.bath.sink_mirror
- ☐ Restock toiletries and toilet paper to host spec
str.bath.restock
- ☐ Replace all towels and bath mats
str.bath.towels
- ☐ Empty trash, replace liner
str.bath.trash

- ☐ Check for guest-left items in cabinets/drawers

str.bath.left_items

BEDROOM(S)

- ☐ Strip all bedding
- ☐ Remake with fresh linens per host spec
- ☐ Dust all surfaces — nightstands, dresser, headboard, lamps
- ☐ Vacuum floor, including under bed where accessible
- ☐ Check closet and drawers for guest-left items
- ☐ Wipe light switches and door handles

str.bed.strip

str.bed.remake

str.bed.dust

str.bed.vacuum

str.bed.left_items

str.bed.touch_points

LIVING AREAS

- ☐ Vacuum and/or mop all floors
- ☐ Dust all surfaces including ceiling fans and remotes
- ☐ Wipe light switches and door handles
- ☐ Straighten furniture and decor to staged position
- ☐ Clean any glass/mirrors

str.living.floors

str.living.dust

str.living.touch_points

str.living.staging

str.living.glass

ENTRY & OUTDOOR

- ☐ Clean entry area, door glass, and welcome zone
- ☐ Clean outdoor furniture if present
- ☐ Empty ashtrays if present
- ☐ Check for guest-left items outdoors
- ☐ Confirm trash/recycling schedule compliance

str.entry.welcome_zone

str.entry.outdoor_furniture

str.entry.ashtrays

str.entry.left_items

str.entry.trash_schedule

HIGH-TOUCH DISINFECTION — EVERY VISIT

- ☐ Door handles (interior and exterior)
- ☐ Light switches
- ☐ Remote controls
- ☐ Cabinet and drawer pulls
- ☐ Faucet handles
- ☐ Toilet flush handles

str.touch.door_handles

str.touch.light_switches

str.touch.remotes

str.touch.pulls

str.touch.faucets

str.touch.flush_handles

- ☐ Stair railings

str.touch.railings

FINAL WALKTHROUGH & STAGING

- ☐ Test appliances (stove, microwave, dishwasher)

str.final.test_appliances

- ☐ Confirm WiFi is working

str.final.wifi

- ☐ Confirm access codes/locks function correctly for the next guest

str.final.access_codes

- ☐ Stage per host's standard property appearance (SPA) reference if one exists

str.final.spa_reference

- ☐ Walk every room one final time, top to bottom, left to right

str.final.room_sweep

- ☐ Take before/after photos — minimum 8–12 covering kitchen, each bathroom, each bedroom, living area, and any issue found

str.final.photos

Timing reference — solo cleaner, standard turnover

Studio / 1BR — 1.5 to 2.5 hrs · 2BR — 2 to 3 hrs · 3BR — 3 to 4 hrs · 4BR+ — 4+ hrs, consider a 2-person crew

Same-day turnovers are high-risk — confirm the cleaner the night before and have a backup plan per the standing coverage system. A delayed check-in from a late turnover is one of the most commonly cited STR complaints.

Part B — Office

Organized by frequency, matching how commercial cleaning contracts are structured and priced.

DAILY — EVERY SCHEDULED VISIT

- ☐ Empty all trash and recycling bins; replace liners
office.daily.trash
- ☐ Disinfect high-touch surfaces: door handles, light switches, elevator buttons, shared phones/keyboards, push bars
office.daily.high_touch
- ☐ Wipe down kitchen/breakroom counters, tables, appliance exteriors
office.daily.breakroom
- ☐ Clean and restock restrooms — toilets, urinals, sinks, mirrors, soap, paper products
office.daily.restrooms
- ☐ Vacuum high-traffic floor areas
office.daily.vacuum_traffic
- ☐ Spot-clean entry glass and reception area
office.daily.entry_glass
- ☐ Straighten common areas and conference rooms
office.daily.common_areas

WEEKLY

- ☐ Detailed floor care — full vacuum of carpeted areas, mop all hard floors
office.weekly.floor_care
- ☐ Interior glass and partition cleaning
office.weekly.glass_partitions
- ☐ Dust baseboards and vents
office.weekly.baseboards_vents
- ☐ Clean appliance interiors
office.weekly.appliance_interiors
- ☐ Deeper restroom scrub, including grout and fixtures
office.weekly.restroom_scrub
- ☐ Dust individual workstations (per desk policy)
office.weekly.workstations
- ☐ Wipe interior door glass and partitions
office.weekly.door_glass

MONTHLY

- ☐ Full interior window detail cleaning
office.monthly.window_detail
- ☐ Carpet extraction in high-traffic zones (or coordinate with specialist vendor)
office.monthly.carpet_extraction
- ☐ Vent and light fixture dusting
office.monthly.vents_fixtures
- ☐ Supply closet audit — restock, check equipment condition
office.monthly.supply_audit
- ☐ Upholstery care in common areas
office.monthly.upholstery

SITE RULES — CONFIRM AT WALKTHROUGH

- ☐ Follow the site's desk policy — clear-desk sites get the full desk surface; do-not-touch-papers sites get dusting around items only
office.rules.desk_policy

- ☐ Confirm out-of-scope areas before starting (server/IT rooms, executive offices, secure storage) per walkthrough findings

office.rules.restricted_areas

- ☐ Service confidential/shredding bins separately from general trash if in scope

office.rules.confidential_waste

Part C — Commercial (by scope level)

Baseline tasks by scope level — Light / Standard / Detailed — applied across facility types, adjusted by walkthrough-specific notes. Each level is the one before it plus more.

LIGHT SCOPE

- ☐ Sweep/vacuum all floors
commercial.light.floors
- ☐ Empty all trash and recycling; replace liners
commercial.light.trash
- ☐ Service restrooms — toilets, sinks, mirrors, restock supplies
commercial.light.restrooms
- ☐ Spot-clean entry glass
commercial.light.entry_glass
- ☐ Wipe down high-touch surfaces (door handles, light switches, push bars)
commercial.light.high_touch

STANDARD SCOPE — INCLUDES LIGHT, PLUS

- ☐ Mop all hard floors
commercial.standard.mop
- ☐ Clean breakroom/kitchen area — counters, tables, appliance exteriors, sink
commercial.standard.breakroom
- ☐ Clean individual offices/rooms per the site's room count
commercial.standard.rooms
- ☐ Dust reachable surfaces in common areas
commercial.standard.dust_common
- ☐ Restock all consumables to par level
commercial.standard.consumables

DETAILED SCOPE — INCLUDES STANDARD, PLUS

- ☐ Scrub restroom tile and grout
commercial.detailed.grout
- ☐ High-touch surface sanitization pass beyond daily wipe-down
commercial.detailed.sanitization
- ☐ Dust vents, light fixtures, and high surfaces
commercial.detailed.high_dusting
- ☐ Interior glass and partition cleaning
commercial.detailed.glass_partitions
- ☐ Baseboard detail cleaning
commercial.detailed.baseboards
- ☐ Deep floor care appropriate to floor type (per walkthrough findings)
commercial.detailed.deep_floor_care

UNIVERSAL RULES — EVERY FACILITY TYPE, EVERY VISIT

- ☐ Follow the access/security procedure recorded at walkthrough — badge, alarm, loading dock protocol
commercial.universal.access
- ☐ Respect the confirmed service window — don't begin before or run past without notifying the office
commercial.universal.window
- ☐ Report any condition beyond scope immediately (mold, pest, biohazard, structural hazard) — stop and report, don't attempt
commercial.universal.report_beyond_scope
- ☐ Before/after photos required, organized by zone/area for larger sites
commercial.universal.photos

- ☐ Crew Lead (if crew of 2+) confirms zone-by-zone completion before the crew leaves

commercial.universal.crew_lead_signoff

Zone documentation — large sites

For any site large enough to use zone-based proof-of-completion, each zone identified at the walkthrough gets its own checklist pass and its own before/after photos — never one generic photo pair representing the whole facility. Follow the zone list established for that site's Firm Price record.

Notes for all three checklists

Property-specific notes always override the generic checklist. Intake or walkthrough notes ("don't touch papers on desks," "host prefers towels rolled not folded," "no chemical cleaners near turf") take precedence for that property, every time.

Photo documentation is not optional on any of the three checklists — it's the evidence that protects both the cleaner and the company in any dispute.

When in doubt, stop and ask. A five-minute pause costs nothing; guessing wrong on scope, access, or an excluded condition costs much more.